



Puppy Foundations

Premium practice worksheet

PUPPY FOUNDATIONS • LESSON 01

Fitdog Puppy Start Checklist

Use this worksheet to build a calm first-week routine, prevent overwhelm, and give your puppy a predictable start at home.

TRAINER NOTE

Keep the first week boring in a good way. Predictability builds confidence faster than constant excitement.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner has a simple first-week routine for potty trips, meals, naps, play, and quiet time so the puppy can settle into the home without chaos.

2 Practice plan

1

Build a simple routine

Map out wake-up, potty, meal, nap, play, and bedtime blocks.

2

Supervise or confine

If you cannot supervise, use the crate or pen instead of giving free roam.

3

Reinforce calm

Reward quiet settles, four paws on the floor, and calm check-ins.

4

Keep day one small

Limit visitors and let the puppy explore in short, low-pressure sessions.



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3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Flat collar or harness with ID tag
- ☐ 6-foot leash and lightweight house line
- ☐ Crate or pen with bedding
- ☐ Chews, stuffed toys, and cleanup supplies

Set up before you start

- ☐ Choose one potty area and one main rest area.
- ☐ Plan meal, nap, potty, and bedtime windows before the puppy arrives.
- ☐ Limit access to one or two rooms so supervision stays easy.

4 First-week routine log

Date	Routine	Dur.	Response	Notes	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Giving the puppy too much space too soon.
- Waiting too long between potty trips.
- Turning every interaction into play and over-arousal.
- Letting children or guests crowd the puppy.

If this happens, try this

- If the puppy seems wild, add a nap and reduce stimulation.
- If the puppy follows you everywhere, use a pen for brief independence reps.
- If accidents happen, shorten the potty schedule and supervise more closely.

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Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can describe our daily puppy routine.
- ☐ My puppy has a clear potty area and rest space.
- ☐ I am rewarding calm behavior throughout the day.
- ☐ I know when to use supervision vs. the pen or crate.

HOMEWORK

Follow the same first-week rhythm for three days in a row. Record potty times, nap windows, and any moments when your puppy settled well on their own.

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Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____